



Patient: Kimani Clark
Date of Birth: 05/09/1972
Ref. Physician: Maximilian Oshalim, MD
Date of Visit: 4/15/2019

Dear Kimani Clark,

You were seen on 4/15/2019 for a consultation visit. Today, the blood pressure is 100/76, the pulse is 81 and the respiratory rate is 12. The height is 72 inches and the weight is 188 lbs with clothes. The calculated BMI is 25.5. At today's visit, you reported taking the following medications: amitriptyline 25 mg, Vitamin D 2,000 IU daily, glutathione 1 tab daily, melatonin 10 mg at 10 PM and Vitamin K. You reported the following drug allergies: No reported drug allergies..

Today we discussed the status of your sleep disorders:

- Delayed sleep phase syndrome (DSPS)
- Insomnia: sleep maintenance

At today's visit, you reported the following medical history:

- Thyroid disease

Based on your visit today, we have discussed and recommend the following:

* You have a clear history of delayed sleep phase syndrome with a well entrained sleep period between 4:15/4:30 AM to Noon/1 AM. In addition you have historically had an early AM awakening with difficulty maintaining sleep through the entire night for the past 10 years or so. This has been responsive to low dose amitriptyline 25 mg in the evening. You have tried stopping or reducing this dose and the underlying problem remains present. Please continue the amitriptyline - it is working well without side effects, I don't believe there is a "better" medication and there is no viable behavioral treatment for the early AM awakening.

• The normal sleep requirement is 7 to 9 hours for adults and you are clear that you need 8 hours of sleep per night. Maintaining this duration of a window of opportunity for sleep is critical. Great variability in the timing of sleep may lead to difficulties initiating sleep at the desired time. It is specifically the wake-up time that is the guidepost (zeitgeber) for the timing of the sleep-wake pattern. Maintaining the wakeup time with minimal variability is key to maintaining a schedule.

GOAL: Do not permit the weekend wakeup time to drift more than 2 hours later than the weekday wakeup time (and in fact the less variability the better!). Your brain takes the wakeup time and will mandate 16 hours of alertness thereafter thus sleeping in late begets a late bedtime the next night.

* Goal: You may track your schedule for 2 weeks to be sure that you are on a consistent pattern of lights out 4:15 AM to Noon/1 PM. Then try to shift the In bed lights out time to 3:45 AM to 11:30 AM weekdays and no later than 12:30 AM on the weekends. Hold the schedule for 3-4 weeks and if you are consistent try to back it up again by 30 minutes, and continue to follow this pattern. Don't move the timing earlier if you are not consistent.

* You may continue to use the melatonin at 3 to 10 mg at 10 PM.

• REMEMBER that LIGHT is a DRUG that promotes WAKEFULNESS! Avoid it at night and augment it in the morning. It is specifically the short frequency blue light portion of the light spectrum that triggers firing in the photopic receptors of the retina to cue your hypothalamus that it is light outside. Unfortunately in our 24/7 "lit" society our electronics are all spilling copious blue light negating the biological period of dusk.

* It is key to block alerting blue light in the evening, after 10 PM with lenses, filters, and frequency (color) specific LED lighting

* Continue to use the orange/red lens glasses you have. If you need more you may consider the inexpensive Uvex orange lens glasses. Search for: UVEX orange lens glasses. They should be about \$9 and the standard UVEX S1933x are fine unless you wear glasses in the evening in which case you may want the larger S0360x model. Wear these in the evening to minimize exposure to light and its alerting affects on your sleep-wake rhythm.

GOAL: wear these for TV, reading, laundry etc after 10 PM

* We set the nightshift program on your iPhone (settings/display and brightness/nightshift) to 10 PM to 7 AM. If you are looking at the phone at all during the night then set the off time to 10 AM rather than 7 AM. Be sure to move the radial button all the way to the right

* Set your MAC computer nightshift program the same way

* Use your digital LED bulbs for nightlights set to orange/red in the evening after 10 PM and full spectrum white or Blue in the AM

* Reinforce morning alertness with Light, Food and a brief 3-5 minute burst of exercise to raise your heart rate (such as 25 sit-ups).

• Keep sleep logs to document the sleep-wake schedule. Tape the log to the bathroom mirror and confess each morning recording your best recollection of your sleep pattern. Please don't clock watch.

* If you are out late maintain the planned wakeup time and then nap between 4 and 6 PM to "catch up". This is a reasonable bail out occasionally!

* Continue to exercise and try to amp it up to 3-5 hours per week. In addition to the general positive health effects people who exercise sleep better.

• Check in with your physicians to be sure that you have had routine complete blood count, chemistry profile, thyroid function studies, a Vitamin B12 level and a Vitamin D level to rule out possible factors contributing to your sleep symptoms. Please ask your doctor(s) to fax over any lab work from the past 12 months.

* If you are able to maintain consistency between the weekday and weekend wakeup times then we may be able to add light via a light box, light visor or light glasses (Luminette) to reinforce AM alertness. Sometimes when the schedule is good this turns out to be unnecessary.

* Follow up visit in 8 weeks to review the sleep logs and your progress if you wish.

Please refer to our website, <http://www.sleepdoc.com> for general information about our practice and different sleep disorders. Prior to your appointments, please complete the follow up questionnaire which can be found on our homepage.

Quick Contacts:

To access your patient plan, prescription history, request medication refills, or to send us a secure message, go to: <http://www.sleepdoc.com/portal>

If you are unable to contact us through the portal with your requests, you can call us. Our phone number is 301-654-1575. Press option 2 to leave a message for a prescription request.